TT-I-542E
April 15, 1975
SUPERSEDING
Fed. Spec. TT-I-542d
September 1, 1965

FEDERAL SPECIFICATION

INK, MARKING, LAUNDRY, BLACK

This specification was approved by the Commissioner, Federal Supply Service, General Services Administration, for the use of all Federal agencies.

1. SCOPE AND CLASSIFICATION

1.1 Scope. This specification covers black laundry marking ink (indelible) for marking all nonsized fabric or fabrics from which the sizing has been removed, of a type suitable for use in a power-operated laundry marking machine, for marking impressions with rubber stamps, and for marking with ball point and other pens suitable for use with subject ink. (See 6.2.1, 6.2.2, and 6.4.)

1.2 Classification.

1.2.1 Type and grade. The marking ink shall be of but one type and grade.

1.2.2 Sizes (individual containers of ink). (See 5.1.1.1.)

2. APPLICABLE DOCUMENTS

2.1 The following documents, of the issues in effect on date of invitation for bids or request for proposal, form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein:

Federal Specifications:

L-P-390 - Plastic, Molding and Extrusion Material, Polyethylene, and Copolymers (Low, Medium, and High Density).
O-S-602 - Sodium Hypochlorite Solution.
P-D-680 - Dry Cleaning Solvent.
PPP-B-566 - Boxes, Folding Paperboard.
PPP-B-636 - Boxes, Shipping, Fiberboard.
PPP-B-665 - Boxes: Paperboard, Metal Edged and Components.
PPP-P-291 - Paperboard, Wrapping and Cushioning.

Federal Standards:

Fed. Std. No. 123 - Marking for Domestic Shipment (Civil Agencies).
Fed. Std. No. 191 - Textile Test Methods.

(Activities outside the Federal Government may obtain copies of Federal Specifications, Standards, and Handbooks as outlined under General Information in the Index of Federal Specifications and Standards at the prices indicated in the Index. The Index, which includes cumulative monthly supplements as issued, is for sale on a subscription basis by the Superintendent of Documents, U.S. Government Printing Office, Washington, DC 20402.

FSC 7510

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(Single copies of this specification and other Federal Specifications required by activities outside the Federal Government for bidding purposes are available without charge from Business Service Centers at the General Services Administration Regional Offices in Boston, New York, Washington, DC, Atlanta, Chicago, Kansas City, MO, Fort Worth, Denver, San Francisco, Los Angeles, and Seattle, WA.

(Federal Government activities may obtain copies of Federal Specifications, Standards, and Handbooks and the Index of Federal Specifications and Standards from established distribution points in their agencies.)

Military Specification:

MIL-L-10547 - Liners, Case, and Sheet, Overwrap, Water-Vaporproof or Waterproof, Flexible.

Military Standards:

MIL-STD-105 - Sampling Procedures and Tables for Inspection by Attributes.
MIL-STD-129 - Marking for Shipment and Storage.

(Copies of Military Specifications and Standards required by suppliers in connection with specific procurement functions should be obtained from the procuring activity or as directed by the contracting officer.)

2.2 Other publications. The following documents form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein. Unless a specific issue is identified, the issue in effect on date of invitation for bids or request for proposal shall apply.

National Motor Freight Traffic Association, Inc., Agent:

National Motor Freight Classification.

(Application for copies should be addressed to the American Trucking Associations, Inc., Tariff Order Section, 1616 P Street, N.W., Washington, DC 20036.)

Uniform Classification Committee, Agent

Uniform Freight Classification.

(Application for copies should be addressed to the Uniform Classification Committee, Room 1106, 222 South Riverside Plaza, Chicago, IL 60606.)

3. REQUIREMENTS

3.1 Materials. The manufacturer is given wide range in the selection of raw materials and processes of manufacture, provided that the ink produced meets the requirements of this specification.

3.2 Acceptance. The acceptance of indelible marking ink as satisfactory shall not relieve the contractor of responsibllity for faulty material (i.e., faulty to the extent that the ink fails to meet the performance requirements herein) which may be discovered within 1 year after procurement provided it has been stored at temperatures in the range of -4° to 50° C.

3.3 Performance in machine. The ink shall not contain any ingredients which will cause the type wheels to fill, gum, or cake so as to produce illegible characters to an extent necessitating cleaning of the type within 1 week after previous cleaning. (Cleaning is considered necessary when, after use, daily brushing with a stiff fiber brush will not clear up illegible characters.) In addition, the ink shall not gum or cake on the ink pad in a manner to require more than one daily renewal of pad.

3.4 Legibility of marks. Marking ink shall produce marks on test fabrics which are clear and legible after one application. There shall be no offsetting or transfer; nor shall there be any discoloration beyond the limits of the marks after 24 hours.

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3.5 Stability. The ink shall comply with the fastness requirements of this specification after being conditioned as specified in 4.4.2.

3.6 Fastness. The ink markings shall remain clearly legible when tested as described in 4.4.3.2, 4.4.3.3, and 4.4.3.4; that is, there shall be no question concerning the identification of any one character marking after completion of the tests.

3.7 pH value. The ink shall have a pH of between 5.0 and 8.0 (see 4.4.4).

3.8. Effect of ink on textiles. The average breaking strength of the ink-stamped fabric shall be not less than 90 percent of the average breaking strength of the uninked portion of the same fabric, when tested as described in 4.4.5.

3.9 Identification marking. Unless otherwise specified, each bottle of ink shall be clearly and legibly lithographed or marked with water-resistant ink, or furnished with a label printed with water-resistant ink on a good grade of printing paper and firmly affixed to the bottle with a water-insoluble adhesive; the markings on the bottle and its individual box where applicable shall clearly identify the product and its manufacturer, and any additional marking shall be in accordance with standard commercial practice. Cautionary marking shall be included to the effect that the ink will be permanent only if applied to fabrics from which sizing, if any, has been removed. (See 5.3, 6.1, and 6.3.)

3.10 Workmanship. The ink shall be a smooth black liquid free from lumps, strings, and objectionable odor. Labels shall be neatly affixed and clearly printed. Ink containers shall show no evidence of spilling or leakage.

4. QUALITY ASSURANCE PROVISIONS

4.1 Responsibility for inspection. Unless otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the supplier is responsible for the performance of all inspection requirements as specified herein. Except as otherwise specified in the contract or order, the supplier may use his own or any other facilities suitable for the performance of the inspection requirements specified herein, unless disapproved by the Government. The Government reserves the right to perform any of the inspections set forth in the specification where such inspections are deemed necessary to assure that supplies and services conform to prescribed requirements.

4.2 Sampling and inspection for acceptance. Sampling and inspection shall be performed in accordance with the provisions of MIL-STD-105, except where otherwise indicated hereinafter. For the purpose of sampling, an inspection lot for acceptance, inspection, and tests shall consist of all material and all bottles of ink of the same size, submitted for inspection and delivery at one time.

4.3 Inspection.

4.3.1 Inspection of materials and components. The supplier is responsible, in accordance with 4.1, for insuring that components and materials used were manufactured, tested, and inspected in accordance with the specified requirements of referenced subsidiary specifications and standards and in accordance with this specification, as applicable.

4.3.2 Inspection of end item.

4.3.2.1 Examination of the end item. The end item shall be examined in accordance with the classification of defects listed for each of the applicable examinations.

4.3.2.1.1 Examination of individual containers of ink for defects in appearance, design, and workmanship. An examination shall be made as indicated in table I. The sample unit for this examination shall be one filled glass bottle or polyethylene container, as applicable. The inspection and acceptable quality levels shall be as specified in 4.3.2.1.4 with the lot size expressed in units of individual containers of ink.

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TABLE I. Visual examination (end item)

Examine	Defects
Appearance	Contains lumps or strings. Stray spilling of ink or leakage on outside of bottle.
Design	Container and closure not as specified.
Fill of individual container (except average contents)	Empty bottle, or filled to extent that bottle may burst or leak in hot weather due to lack of liquid expansion space.

4.3.2.1.2 Examination of individual container for average contents. The sample unit for this examination shall be one filled glass bottle or polyethylene container, as applicable. The inspection level shall be as specified in 4.3.2.1.4 with the lot size expressed in units of bottles or containers, as applicable. The average contents shall be not less than that specified.

4.3.2.1.3 Examination of preparation for delivery. An examination shall be made to determine compliance with the packaging, packing, and marking requirements of section 5. Defects shall be scored in accordance with table II. For examination of contents, the sample unit shall be one shipping container prepared for delivery, selected just prior to the closing operations. Defects of closure specified shall be examined on shipping containers fully prepared for delivery. The lot size shall be the number of shipping containers in the end-item inspection lot. The inspection level shall be S-4 with an acceptable quality level (AQL) of 4.0 defects per 100 units.

TABLE II. Examination of preparation for delivery

Examine	Defects
Markings - (unit, intermediate, and exterior containers, as applicable)	Incorrect; omitted; illegible; improper size, location sequence, or method of application; omission "THIS SIDE UP" and other warnings.
Materials	Wrong type, class or other category of required specifications. Material missing, damaged, or defective, affecting serviceability.
Workmanship	Wrong or careless means in placement and use of labeling and packaging and packing materials such as loose or partially attached labels; flaps of containers incompletely closed; loose or overtight straps, dangerous strap ends, and smeared adhesive.
Contents	Quantities of unit and intermediate containers not as specified. Wrong arrangement; bottle on side or upside down.
Closure of shipping containers	Not as specified.
Gross weight of shipping containers	In excess of specified weight. In excess of box limitation shown on boxmaker's certificate.

4.3.2.1.4 Inspection levels and AQL's. The inspection levels and acceptable quality levels for examination of the end item shall be as follows:

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Specification reference	Inspection level	AQL
4.3.2.1.1	S-4	2.5
4.3.2.1.2	S-2 (see 4.3.2.1.3)	---

4.3.2.2 Testing of ink. Each lot or batch of marking ink shall be tested in accordance with 4.4. Each sample unit shall meet all requirements. One sample unit shall consist of sixteen ounces from one or more bottles of marking ink.

4.4 Tests.

4.4.1 Test materials. Samples of print cotton cloth, woolen bunting, viscose rayon, and acetate rayon twills, shall be used in testing indelible marking ink, unless the purchaser limits the application of marking ink to one or more kinds of fabrics (see 6.1.1), in which case the samples shall be limited to those kinds of fabrics. The test cloth shall be substantially free of sizing which may interfere with the application of the ink. (See 6.4.)

4.4.2 Stability. Samples of the ink shall be placed in two well-stoppered containers. One container shall be placed in an atmosphere maintained at a temperature of -4° + 1° C. for 24 hours. The other container shall be placed in an atmosphere maintained at a temperature of 50° + 1° C. for 24 hours. Both samples shall be allowed to return to room temperature before each is applied to test specimens and tested for fastness as specified in 4.4.3.

4.4.3 Fastness tests. (See 6.3 and 6.4.)

4.4.3.1 Test specimens. The ink shall be applied with one impression consisting of eight characters, on three portions of each test material, as applicable (see 4.4.1). A power-operated marking machine shall be used for the application (see 6.3). The specified specimens shall be subjected to the tests described in 4.4.3.2, 4.4.3.3, and 4.4.3.4 not less than 15 minutes and not more than 20 minutes after application of the ink. All specified materials shall be subjected to tests for fastness to laundering and dry cleaning; only cotton materials, as applicable (see 4.4.1) shall be tested for fastness to bleaching and antichlor (sodium bisulfite).

4.4.3.2 Fastness to laundering. Fastness to laundering shall be determined by the procedures described in Fed. Std. No. 191, methods 5610 and 5614, for cotton material and for woolen and rayon materials, respectively. A 4 by 4 inch specimen shall be used, in lieu of the prescribed 2 by 4 inch sample, in each jar. The operations of laundering, rinsing, and drying shall be performed 15 times on each specimen.

4.4.3.3 Fastness to dry cleaning. Fastness to dry cleaning shall be determined by the following procedure: Place the test specimen in a 16-ounce (1 pint) preserve jar containing 150 milliliters of dry cleaning solvent (Spec. P-D-680) and 10 non-corroding steel balls of 3/8 inch diameter. Agitate in a launder-Ometer or similar laundering machine, as described in Fed. Standard No. 191, method 5610, for 20 minutes. Remove specimen from jar, extract excess solvent in a centrifuge, and lay out on a horizontal surface, such as a screen, to dry at a temperature of 71° + 2°C. Press dry specimen in accordance with Fed. Standard No. 191, method 5550. The operations of treating, rinsing, drying, and pressing shall each be performed five times.

4.4.3.4 Fastness to bleaching and antichlor (sodium bisulfite). (See 4.4.3.1.)

4.4.3.4.1 Bleaching solution. A stock of bleaching solution shall be prepared by diluting with distilled water to 1.4 percent of available chlorine, the concentrated material as described in O-S-602. One hundred milliliters of this stock solution shall be further diluted with 1300 milliliters of distilled water, and the test specimens shall be immersed therein at a temperature of 71° + 1° C. (160° + 1.8°F.) for 5 minutes and rinsed, as described in Fed. Standard No. 191, method 5610. The test specimens shall be immediately transferred to a solution of sodium bisulfite, as described in 4.4.3.4.2.

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4.4.3.4.2 Sodium bisulfite. The sodium bisulfite solution shall contain 5 grams of sodium bisulfite to 1 liter of distilled water. The test specimens shall be immersed in the solution at a temperature of 71° ± 1° C. (160° ± 1.8° F.) for 5 minutes and then rinsed and dried, as described in Fed. Std No. 191, method 5610. These operations of treating the test specimens with the bleaching solution and then rinsing them followed by the treatment with the sodium bisulfite solution, then rinsing and drying, shall be performed 10 times.

4.4.4 Determination of pH of water extract of ink.

4.4.4.1 Test specimen. A sample of 10 grams of marking ink shall be used.

4.4.4.2 Test apparatus and reagent. A 4 ounce glass bottle with a nonmetallic stopper; an accurate potentiometric pH apparatus having calomel and glass electrodes calibrated with 0.05M potassium acid phthalate (pH of 4.008 at 25° ± 0.5° C.); and distilled water with a pH of 6.5 ± 0.5, shall be used.

4.4.4.3 Procedure. Forty milliliters of distilled water and 10 grams of the ink shall be poured into the bottle. The bottle shall be stoppered and the contents shall be shaken for 1/2-minute at each 5 minute interval until 1/2-hour has elapsed. The bottle and contents shall be allowed to stand without further agitation for an additional 1/2-hour. The temperature shall then be regulated to 25° ± 0.5° C. and the pH measured.

4.4.5 Effect of ink on textiles.

4.4.5.1 Ten-day test. Five 12 by 2 inch specimens of each test material, as applicable (see 4.4.4.1), shall be prepared, with the warp running in the long direction. Each specimen shall be stamped approximately 3 inches from one end across the width, with the ink producing a well-covered black impression. The ink shall be applied with a rubber stamp 1/2-inch wide, from a pad adequately inked and not previously used. All samples shall then be stored in a room maintained at a relative humidity of 65 ± 2 percent and a temperature of 21° ± 5° C. for 10 days. After conditioning, the specimens shall be cut to a length of 6 inches and a width of 1-1/2 inches, then ravelled to 1 inch removing approximately an equal number of yarns from each side, and the breaking strength determined as specified in Fed. Std. No. 191, method 5104.

4.4.5.2 Accelerated aging test. Five 12 by 2 inch specimens of each test material, as applicable (see 4.4.1), shall be prepared, with the warp running in the long direction. All specimens shall be stamped approximately 3 inches from one end of each 12 inch strip across the width, with the ink producing a well-covered black impression. The ink shall be applied from a pad, using a rubber stamp 1/2-inch wide. The specimens shall then be conditioned for 24 hours at 211° ± 5° C. and 65 ± 2 percent relative humidity. The specimens shall then be laundered as outlined in Fed. Std. No. 191, methods 5610 and 5614. After drying, the specimens shall be cut to a length of 6 inches and a width of 1-1/2 inches, then ravelled to 1 inch removing approximately an equal number of yarns from each side. Prepared specimens shall be placed in a well-ventilated oven, having a circulation of air about 150 cubic feet per minute, at 149° ± 1° C. for 1 hour. After removal from the oven, the specimens shall be conditioned at 21° ± 5° C. and 65 ± 2 percent relative humidity before testing for breaking strength, as specified in Fed. Std. No. 191, method 5104.

4.4.6 Permeability test. Two ink-filled 2 ounce polyethylene containers of each inspection sample and five ink-filled 2 ounce glass bottles of the same marking ink representing control samples shall be sealed with paraffin wax along the edge of the stoppers, and individually weighed at room temperature. The ink and containers shall then be placed inside a temperature controlled test chamber and maintained at a temperature of 100° F. ± 1° F. for 28 consecutive days. After this period of time, the containers shall be removed, allowed to cool at room temperature for 1 day, and reweighed. The average weight loss of the test samples minus the average weight loss of the control samples shall be the average weight loss of the test samples due to permeation. If the average weight loss is greater than 0.4 gram per 2 ounce container, the lot shall be rejected. (See 5.1.1.1.)

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5. PREPARATION FOR DELIVERY

5.1 Packaging. Unless otherwise specified, packaging shall be level A or C, as specified (see 6.2).

5.1.1 Level A.

5.1.1.1 Unit package. Two, four, sixteen, and thirty-two ounces of ink shall be packaged in 2, 4, 16, and 32 ounce size bottles, respectively, and shall be furnished as specified (see 6.2). The bottles shall be fabricated from commercial grade glass or from polyethylene material conforming to type I, grade 1 of L-P-390. If a polyethylene container is used, the average weight loss due to permeation of the ink through the container shall not exceed 0.4-gram per 2 ounce container when tested as specified in 4.4.6. Each 2, 4, 16, and 32 ounce bottle shall be provided with a metal or plastic continuous-thread screw-cap closure (see 5.1.1.1.1). Plastic caps, when furnished, shall be of adequate weight sidewall so that an average of not more than 10 out of 30 caps will be broken in application by capping machines at 30 inch-pounds torque and no individual cap will break at less than 15 inch-pounds. Screw caps shall have a nonabsorbent resilient lining or a lining backed by resilient material which will remain in the cap, in accordance with normal commercial practice. An inner seal, in accordance with normal commercial practice shall be used to cover and adhere to the mouth of the 2, 4, 16, and 32 ounce bottles which will prevent loss of the contents should the cap become loosened. Caps shall be tightened to prevent leakage. Each glass bottle shall be packaged in a snug-fitting box conforming to style II, type D, class A of PPP-B-566. Boxes containing bottles of 2 or 4 ounce size shall have tuck ends of a lock type as illustrated in figure 2 of PPP-B-566 for the style of box specified. In addition, each box containing 16 or 32 ounce glass bottles shall be fitted with a single-faced corrugated liner, constructed from material conforming to PPP-P-291. Each individual box containing 16 or 32 ounce bottles shall be sealed with tape as specified in the appendix to the box specification.

5.1.1.1.1 Alternate closure. Alternate continuous-thread screw-cap closure for the 2, 4, 16, and 32 ounce size bottles, of pour-out type or other design in accordance with normal commercial practice, will be acceptable provided the alternate closure meets the quality established by this specification and is at least equally effective to that described above for the purpose intended.

5.1.1.2 Intermediate package. Ink, unit packaged as specified in 5.1.1.1, except for 16 and 32 ounce bottles, shall be intermediate-packaged in quantities as specified in table III, in a snug-fitting box as specified in 5.1.1.1 or alternately intermediate-packaged as specified in note 1 to table III. Sixteen and thirty-two ounce bottles shall be intermediate-packaged in boxes conforming to PPP-B-665 or CF or SF, class domestic of PPP-B-636; in quantities as indicated in table III.

TABLE III

Size (ounces)	Quantity of unit packages per intermediate package	Quantity of unit packages per shipping container
2	1/ 12	144
4	1/ 12	144
16	6	48
32	6	24

1/ Alternate intermediate packaging: Two boxes, each tightly wrapped with draft paper and each containing 6 unit packages as specified in 5.1.1.1 may be inserted in a snug-fitting box (intermediate package) as specified in 5.1.1.2 to comply with the requirement for 12 unit packages per intermediate package.

5.1.2 Level C. Each bottle of ink as specified in 5.1.1.1 shall be packaged in accordance with normal commercial practice, providing that this will insure protection during shipment and safe delivery at destination.

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5.2 Packing. Unless otherwise specified, packing shall be level A, B, or C, as specified (see 6.2).

5.2.1 Level A. Bottles, packaged as specified in 5.1, shall be packed in quantities as shown in table III in a snug-fitting box conforming to V3c or V3s, style CSSC-L of PPP-B-636. Each shipping container shall be fitted with a taped one-piece double-wall corrugated liner provided with a type I or II, grade B or C, class 2 sealed case liner conforming to MIL-L-10547, placed between the corrugated liner and the inner surfaces of the box. Each box shall be closed and strapped in accordance with the appendix to the box specification.

5.2.2 Level B. Bottles, packaged as specified in 5.1, shall be packed in quantities as specified in table III in a snug-fitting box conforming to type CF or SF, Class domestic, of PPP-B-636, grade 200 minimum and each box shall be furnished with top and bottom pads of grade 200 minimum single-wall "C" flute fiberboard. Closure of boxes shall be in accordance with method II of the appendix to the box specification.

5.2.3 Level C. Individual containers, packaged as specified in 5.1, shall be packed in shipping containers of the type, size, and kind commonly used in commercial practice, in a manner that will insure acceptance by common carriers and safe delivery at destination. Shipping containers shall comply with the National Motor Freight Classification rules of the Uniform Freight Classification rules.

5.3 Marking. In addition to the special marking required by 5.3.3, intermediate packages and shipping containers shall be marked in accordance with 5.3.1 or 5.3.2 as specified (see 6.2).

5.3.1 Civil Agencies. Marking shall be in accordance with Fed. Std. No. 123.

5.3.2 Military agencies. Marking shall be in accordance with MIL-STD-129.

5.3.3 Special marking. Each shipping container containing glass bottles shall bear "FRAGILE" markings. All shipping containers shall bear arrows and the word "UP" on at least one side and one end and the words "TOP" and "THIS SIDE UP" on the top surface.

6. NOTES

6.1 Intended use. Ink covered by this specification is intended for use in the marking of all nonsized fabrics or fabrics from which the sizing has been removed.

6.2 Ordering data. Purchasers should select the preferred options permitted herein, and include the following information in procurement documents:

(a) Title, number, and date of this specification.
(b) Limitation, if any, as to kind of fabrics to which ink is to be applied (see 6.2.1).
(c) Data, as required; inspection responsibility if other than as specified (see 4.1).
(d) Size of unit package (individual ink container, see 5.1.1.1).
(e) Marking of unit packages, if different (see 3.9).
(f) Levels of packaging and packing any special marking for shipment required (see 5.1, 5.2, and 5.3).

6.2.1 Limitation of application. The purchaser may limit the application of laundry marking ink to one or more types of fabrics (see 4.4.1); any such limitation should be specified in the invitation for bids.

6.2.2 Whenever marking ink is required for the marking of new garments or linens that will remain in storage after marking, before being issued or before being laundered, it should be specifically stated in the invitation for bids. This precaution is necessary because some types of marking inks are toxic, while others will cause some white materials that contain sizing, to develop a pink color in the area around the marking during storage. (See 6.4.)

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6.3 A power-operated marking machine having eight or more type wheels with alphabet, numerals, and other special characters of 12-point size should be used when marking test material for the fastness determination.

6.4 In order that indelible laundry ink can penetrate to the fibers, sizing agents should be removed from sized fabrics by washing the fabrics at least once. When heavily sized fabrics are marked, much, if not all, of the ink will be removed during the first washing.

6.5 Federal specifications do not include all types, classes, grades, sizes, etc., of the commodities indicated by the titles of the specifications or which are commercially available, but are intended to cover the types, etc., which are suitable for Federal Government requirements.

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